



Tips & Tricks



Free-up some disk space

Filesystem type ext2 and later versions use 5 per cent of their capacity for root processes (for logs, etc) only. It's apt for root partitions on small sized disks. But on large or non-root partitions, it wastes a lot of space. So you can reduce it, say to 3 per cent, to reclaim some disk space using the following command (as the super-user):

```
#tune2fs -m 3 /dev/sda1
```

For non-root partitions (like /home) you can remove that reserved area altogether, using the command below (of course, as the super-user):

```
tune2fs -r 0 /dev/sda2
```

...assuming /dev/sda1 is your /root partition and /dev/sda2 is /home.

—Apinder Singh, as.nv.del@gmail.com



Check the time of the executed command

To check the time of the executed command, the environment variable for *bash* needs to be set as HISTTIMEFORMAT. After setting the variable you need to just execute the following command:

```
#export HISTTIMEFORMAT="%F %T %"
```

Now, check the history by executing the command below.

```
#history
```

The output would be as shown below:

```
264 2010-01-19 22:25:17 vi servicegroups.cfg
```

```
265 2010-01-19 22:25:17 vi /etc/hosts
266 2010-01-19 22:25:17 vi hosts.cfg
267 2010-01-19 22:25:17 vi services.cfg
268 2010-01-19 22:25:17 vi servicegroups.cfg
269 2010-01-19 22:25:17 /etc/init.d/nagios restart
270 2010-01-19 22:25:17 vi services.cfg
271 2010-01-19 22:25:17 /etc/init.d/nagios restart
272 2010-01-19 22:25:17 date
273 2010-01-19 22:25:17 vi servicegroups.cfg
```

—Shyam kumar, shyam.verma@indoasian.com



Run background commands or jobs

A task can usually be started and run as a background task by putting an '&' symbol at the end of the command line.

If a task is running in the foreground, it is still possible to move it to the background without cancelling it. To move a task from the foreground to the background, perform the following steps:

1. **CTRL-Z**
This will suspend the current foreground job (task).

2. Enter the job control command 'bg'

3. Tap the 'Enter' key

The job is now running in the background.

Useful commands to see which jobs are still running are the 'jobs' or 'ps ua' commands. If the 'jobs' command is used, a background job can be brought to the foreground with the command 'fg j' where 'j' is the job (not the PID) number.

—Dange Laxmikant M, dange.laxmikant@gmail.com



Temporarily stop/start a process in Linux

Sometimes we require a particular job to stop for a certain period of time and start again.